



800–1545

New ideas

For much of the Middle Ages, China, India, and the Islamic world led the way in science, with advances in mathematics, medicine, engineering, and navigation. Europe began to catch up when translations of Ancient Greek and Roman works, held in Arabic libraries but long lost elsewhere, arrived in the West. In the 15th century, the rediscovery of this knowledge inspired the Renaissance, a period of new interest in classical arts and thinking. As old ideas were revisited and questioned, science in Europe took great steps forward.